issues should take the views of the people of J&K into consideration.

- The military has performed its role perfectly by bringing down the levels of violence considerably, and shall continue to do so. Now it is for the elected representatives of the people to meaningfully address the problems of the common man. These are primarily related to their socioeconomic development. In this regard, the sincerity of purpose of the current government led by Omar Abdullah is beyond doubt and praiseworthy.
- There must be peace and the gun culture must end. The people must not provide support to organizations which use violence as a tool to achieve their vested interests. This requires the same level of courage and determination as was shown by the people of Punjab to root out extremism.
- The psyche of the 'awaam' (people) has been seriously traumatized due to the violence of the past two decades. A healing touch is needed, and a humane approach needs to be adopted while dealing with the common man.
- It would be a step in the right direction to ensure that besides the army, the law enforcement agencies, such as the paramilitary forces and the police, should have a reduced signature and benign presence.
- Greater people-to-people contacts may be allowed along the LoC, along with an enhanced level of border trade, covering more areas.
- Economic activity should be accelerated so that more avenues are created for the employment of the youth. Tourism, industry, handicrafts and horticulture have great potential, which is yet to be exploited. But these would need a peaceful environment, above all else.

Militancy in the Northeast